

DONALD DUCK BAY

Complete Travel & Tour Guide — Similan Islands, Thailand

Quick Overview

Donald Duck Bay (Ao Kuerk) is the famous postcard bay on Similan Island No. 8 in Mu Ko Similan National Park, Phang Nga Province, Thailand. It is known for soft white sand, clear water, granite boulders and the Sail Rock viewpoint overlooking the bay. The bay gets its English name from a distinctive rock formation resembling a duck.

Location & Access

The usual way to visit is on a day trip by speedboat from Thap Lamu Pier, near Khao Lak, or from Phuket with a road transfer to the pier. Typical operators leave early and reach the islands in the morning. A representative itinerary reaches Donald Duck Bay around 10:15–10:30, followed by beach time and a short hike to Sail Rock.

Best Things to Do

- Hike to Sail Rock for the classic panoramic view.
- Relax and swim on the white-sand beach when conditions allow.
- Snorkel at designated Similan Island reef sites.
- Photograph the distinctive granite formations and turquoise water.
- Combine the visit with Islands 7, 9 and 4 for a full-day Similan experience.

Sample Full-Day Itinerary

Time	Activity
05:00–07:30	Hotel transfer/check-in depending on departure point and operator.
08:00–09:00	Pier check-in, light breakfast and safety/reef briefing.
09:00	Speedboat departure toward the Similan Islands.
10:15–11:30	Donald Duck Bay, Island 8: beach time and hike to Sail Rock.
11:30–12:30	Snorkelling around Island 9 / Coral Bay.
12:30–13:30	Lunch and relaxation on Island 4.
13:30–15:00	Additional snorkelling or island/beach time, depending on operator.
15:00–17:30	Return to pier and transfer to hotel.

Best Time to Visit

The Similan Islands are generally visited during the national-park operating season, commonly around mid-October to mid-May. Exact opening/closing dates and access rules can change, so confirm the current season and weather before booking. Sea conditions can affect itineraries.

What to Bring

Swimwear • towel • reef-safe sunscreen • sunglasses • hat • dry bag/waterproof phone pouch • reusable water bottle • light cover-up • motion-sickness medicine if needed • cash for incidental purchases. Wear secure footwear for the rocky viewpoint trail.

Safety & Practical Tips

Follow your guide and park rules. The Sail Rock path can be steep and uneven, so take care and avoid climbing beyond marked/safe areas. Sea conditions can change quickly; swimming and boat movements should follow crew instructions. Avoid touching coral or marine life and use reef-friendly sunscreen.

Typical Tour Inclusions

Many organized tours include hotel/pier transfers, speedboat transport, national-park fees, guide, snorkeling equipment, life jacket, breakfast/snacks, lunch, drinks and travel insurance. Inclusions vary by operator, so check the exact package before paying.

Important Note

Donald Duck Bay is part of Mu Ko Similan National Park. Tour schedules, park access, fees, routes and permitted activities can change because of weather, sea conditions, conservation rules or official park decisions. Treat the itinerary in this guide as a planning example rather than a guaranteed timetable.

Planning Reference

Current tour materials describe Donald Duck Bay as Island No. 8 and the Sail Rock viewpoint as the signature viewpoint above the bay. Recent operator itineraries also combine it with snorkeling and visits to other Similan islands.